

Week 2 at a Glance

Wednesday–Saturday, September 16–19, 2026 · about two hours each morning · AO Year 2 Term 1 week 2

EVERY SCHOOL DAY

- Outdoor sit or walk, 20 min
- Bible, 10–15 min, then narrate
- Hymn or folk song, 5 min
- Ray’s Arithmetic, next lesson, 15–20 min
- Copywork, one line, 10 min
- Recitation, 5 min
- One main reading + narration
- One lighter reading or riches

HOLD ALL WEEK

Copywork: I know a little cupboard

Recitation: Genesis 1:1
In the beginning God created the heaven and the earth.

Hymn: first stanza of “I Bind Unto Myself Today”

Folk song: “The Bold Grenadier” — preview lyrics

Math: next Ray’s lesson. One sitting. Oral first when the book allows.

DAY	BIBLE	MAIN READING	RICHES / EXTRA
Wed 16	Exodus 4	Island Story ch. 23, Stamford Bridge	Nature sit · “The Cupboard” · hymn
Thu 17	Exodus 5	Little Duke, ch. 1 second half	Burgess Animal Book ch. 2 · folk song
Fri 18	Exodus 6 (omit 14–25)	CHOW, two emperors / Charlemagne	Map + compass · Rockwell · hymn
Sat 19	Luke 19:10–27	Understood Betsy ch. 1	Pilgrim’s Progress · Bernstein · evening walk

Books to have open

- Bible
- Ray’s Arithmetic
- Our Island Story*, ch. 23
- The Little Duke*, finish ch. 1
- Hillyer, *A Child’s History of the World* (first sitting)
- Burgess Animal Book*, ch. 2
- Understood Betsy*, ch. 1
- de la Mare, “The Cupboard” in *Peacock Pie*
- Cheap compass · England / Europe map · nature notebook

Skip *Tree in the Trail* ch. 2–3 (not PD) and *Trial and Triumph* (not on this week’s list).

Two children

The 2nd grader does the whole morning. The preschooler joins Bible, songs, poems, animal stories, picture study, and outside. During math, copywork, and heavier history they play nearby with quiet work.

Heat

Bastrop in September. Outside at 8am or after 6pm. Not midday. Times on the day pages slide; keep the order.

New this week

First CHOW sitting (Charlemagne). First *Understood Betsy*. Finish *Little Duke* ch. 1. Do not stack *Island Story* and CHOW.

Free sources

Island Story: archive.org · Little Duke: Gutenberg 3048 · CHOW 1924: Gutenberg 67149 · Burgess: 2441 · Understood Betsy: 5347 · “The Cupboard” in *Peacock Pie*: 3753 · PP: 131.

READINGS IN THIS PACKET

You may want to buy (or borrow)

These will not be printed in the packet. Get them two or three weeks before we need them. Library is fine. Skip any you already own.

HAVE BY WEEK 5 · EARLY OCTOBER

Tree in the Trail by Holling C. Holling. AO geography for Term 1. We skipped it in weeks 1–2 because it is not public domain. If you want the story, have it by Week 5 and we will start then. If not, we keep skipping it.

OPTIONAL · SAME WINDOW

Trial and Triumph by Richard Hannula. Church-history stories. AO says you may skip the book. Next chapter if you use it: Week 5, Alfred. Preview first; some of the trials are intense for this age.

LATER THIS YEAR, NOT NOW

Seabird (Holling) around Week 19. Diane Stanley's *Joan of Arc* around Week 25. I will flag those again when they are three weeks out.

If you already own one of these, say so and I will write it into the week instead of skipping.

When Children Love to Learn

Elaine Cooper, ed. This week: Chapter 2, “The Child is a Person.” Read it once. Do not take notes for a quiz. Let it change how you sit with them.

THIS WEEK’S READING

Chapter 2 · The Child is a Person. About twenty minutes, sometime before Wednesday school. Not during the children’s lessons.

What to do with it

The 2nd grader is a person who can tell a story back.
The preschooler is a person too, not a lesson to finish.
After you read Cooper’s chapter, watch for one moment this week when you almost prompt, bribe, or rush. Stop. Wait.

In the lessons

Narration is how a person shows they know. Read once. Close the book. Let them talk. Do not turn Little Duke or Understood Betsy into a questionnaire. If they give three true sentences, that is enough.

What not to do

No stickers for finishing math. No “and then what?” while they narrate. No comparing the 2nd grader to anyone. Ray’s is still one lesson. Stop while they are still with you.

Mason’s student motto, if you want it on the wall

I am, I ought, I can, I will. For a child: I am a child of God. I ought to do His will. I can do what He tells me. By His grace, I will. Say it once this week if it fits. Do not drill it.

Coming weeks in this book

Week 3: Chapter 3, Atmosphere.
Week 4: Chapter 3, Discipline (habits).
Week 5: Chapter 3, Life (ideas, not stuffing).
Week 6: Chapter 3, Science of Relations.
Then Chapter 4, one distinctive at a time (living books, narration, nature, and the rest).

If you only do one thing

Read the chapter. On Thursday, after Little Duke, wait a full ten seconds before you speak. That is the lesson for you.

This page is original notes pointing to your book. It is not a reprint of Cooper.

How to teach this week

Same habits as week 1. New books, new stop-points. You are not a textbook.

01 Narration is still the lesson

Read once, close the book, let the child tell it back. Do not interrupt. Do not prompt with “and then what?” A few true sentences are enough. Thank them. Do not grade it. This week they will narrate a battle, a father’s visit, a new history book, and a new American story. One reading at a time.

02 Do not stack two histories

Island Story (Wednesday) is England, 1066. CHOW (Friday) is Charlemagne, about 800. They belong on different days. If you miss Wednesday, do Stamford Bridge Thursday and slide Little Duke — do not put both histories in one morning.

03 Copywork, a new line

Week 1 was the moon line from “Silver.” This week: *I know a little cupboard*, from de la Mare’s “The Cupboard.” Show the line. Best handwriting. Then stop. If the hand tires, fewer words tomorrow.

04 Recitation, keep the verse

Genesis 1:1 together, then they try. When it is solid, add the first two lines of “The Cupboard.” Do not drop the verse to start the poem. A poem learned by heart is a gift, not a test.

05 Ray’s Arithmetic

Next lesson. No numbers from me. Oral first when the book allows. If they miss two in a row, stop and try those tomorrow. Preschooler: quiet work in the same room.

06 Bible without a sermon

Exodus 4–6 is heavier than week 1. Moses still objects. Pharaoh makes the work worse. Skip the name-list in 6:14–25. Read, narrate, one true sentence, stop. Saturday’s parable is for both children. It is the minas (gold coins), not Matthew’s talents.

07 Two children in one room

Preschooler sits for living stories, songs, poems, Burgess, picture study, and nature. They are not expected to narrate Stamford Bridge or Charlemagne. During math, copywork, and CHOW, give them quiet work: blocks, crayons, playdough, a basket of pinecones. If they melt, send them outside and keep going with the 2nd grader.

08 Stamford Bridge follows Harold

Week 1 ended with Harold king. This chapter is the north: Tostig, the Norwegian king, the fight at the bridge, then news that William has landed in the south. **Do not read Hastings** (ch. 24, next week). Narration: who came, what happened at the bridge, what news came after. Timeline: Stamford Bridge, 1066.

09 Finish Little Duke chapter 1

Week 1 was the boy, Bayeux, the castle. This sitting is the father’s visit: reading, forgiving enemies, the silver key, then William rides away. Finish the chapter. **Do not open chapter 2** (the messengers). That is next week. Gutenberg 3048 if you need the text.

10 First CHOW sitting

AO week 2 is later-edition **ch. 47 “Two Empires, Two Emperors.”** The 1924 Gutenberg text numbers the same Charlemagne chapter as **ch. 45 “A Light in the Dark Ages.”** Use whichever matches the book in your hand. Cap at 20 minutes. This is France and the year 800, not England. Place “Charlemagne, about 800” on the timeline — more than a hundred years before Harold.

How to teach this week

New books. Same short lessons. Stop while they still want more.

11 Understood Betsy is long

Chapter 1, “Aunt Harriet Has a Cough,” is the first sitting of this book and it runs long. Stop at twenty minutes even if they beg. Narrate who Elizabeth Ann lives with, and what went wrong. If the chapter is not done, a second 15-minute sitting after Saturday’s notebook. Finish ch. 1 this week; week 3 is ch. 2. Gutenberg 5347.

12 Pilgrim’s Progress, still gentle

Official AO week 2 is the rest of the verse Apology. Last week you skipped that for a simple overview. Stay on that path: the dream-picture of a man in rags, a book, a burden, “What shall I do?” Then stop. Evangelist waits. If you would rather match AO’s 72-week text exactly, read the rest of the Apology instead and save the dream for week 3.

13 Burgess is the easy science

Chapter 2: Peter and Jumper go to school. Cottontail and hare, snowshoe feet, a cousin who swims. Both children. Narrate one true difference between Peter and Jumper. That is the whole lesson. No classification chart.

14 Nature is still looking

Lost Pines, mid-September, heat. One invertebrate: an orb web at 8am, a cicada shell on a loblolly, ants, a cricket at dusk, a millipede under bark if it has rained. Watch for fire ants. Names only if they ask. Saturday evening is the longer hunt.

15 Picture study, second look

Same Rockwell: *Freedom of Speech*. Four quiet minutes. Turn it over. They tell what was in the picture, then one thing they did not say last week. Look again. Library book or museum image. Do not print a packet. Copyright still holds; looking is the lesson.

16 Map, then compass

Term geography is still the compass. This week also place two stories: York and the North Sea (Stamford Bridge); France or Aachen (Charlemagne). Hide the compass. Let the 2nd grader point north. Preschooler plays “find north.” No worksheet.

17 Music, same excerpt

Bernstein’s *Jeremiah* again, five to eight minutes while they draw. Familiarity comes from hearing, not from explaining. No quiz. Legal stream or library recording.

18 If it falls apart

Skip to outdoor time. Pick up tomorrow. A song and a walk still count as school. If you must cut a day, keep Bible, Ray’s, and that day’s main reading. Riches can wait.

19 Folk song caution

Still preview “The Bold Grenadier.” Some old verses are not for children. Sing a clean set. Hymn: only the first stanza of the Breastplate this month.

20 What you are skipping

Tree in the Trail ch. 2–3 is on AO’s week 2 list and is not public domain. Skip it unless the book is already in the house. *Trial and Triumph* is not assigned this week. Shakespeare is not on this week’s list unless a leftover page from week 1 is marked.

Wednesday

HAVE READY

Bible · hymn words · Ray's · copywork line · *Our Island Story* ch. 23 · "The Cupboard" · nature notebook

8:00 **Nature sit** PRESCHOOLER JOINS

Backyard or porch. Twenty minutes. One thing only: an orb web in morning light, a cicada shell on a loblolly pine, ants on the path, or a grasshopper. Look. Do not name everything. Sketch if they want. This drawing comes back on Saturday.

8:25 **Bible · Exodus 4**

God Calls Moses. Staff, the hand, Aaron as mouth, Moses turns toward Egypt. Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. One true sentence if needed: God does not send Moses alone. Then stop.

8:40 **Hymn** PRESCHOOLER JOINS

First stanza of "I Bind Unto Myself Today" (St. Patrick's Breastplate). Still only the opening this month. Sing. Do not explain it to death.

8:50 **Ray's Arithmetic**

Next lesson, 15–20 min. Oral first if the book allows. Stop while attention is still on. Preschooler: quiet work nearby.

9:10 **Copywork & recitation**

Copy: *I know a little cupboard*. Best handwriting, then stop. Recite Genesis 1:1 together, then they try.

9:25 **History · *Our Island Story*, ch. 23**

"The Battle of Stamford Bridge." Last week Harold was king. This week the north. Stop at 20 minutes. Do not start Hastings. Narrate: who came to fight Harold, what happened at the bridge, what news came after. Place "Stamford Bridge, 1066" on the timeline.

9:50 **Movement, then poem** PRESCHOOLER JOINS

Run around the house or stretch. Then read de la Mare's "The Cupboard" once. No talk after unless they start it. Books done about 10:10. Free play.

If the morning slips, keep Bible, Ray's, Stamford Bridge, and the nature sit. Drop the hymn and poem to tomorrow.

How to teach Wednesday

A battle chapter and a cupboard poem in the same morning is the point. Variety, then stop.

Exodus 4 — God Calls Moses

Week 1 ended at the bush. Today Moses still does not want to go. Signs are given. Aaron will speak. They turn toward Egypt. Read the chapter once. Close the book. Let the 2nd grader tell it. If they stall, wait. One sentence from you is enough: God does not send him alone. The preschooler may only hold “a stick that became a snake.” That is fine. Do not unpack every name of God.

Island Story, ch. 23 — Stamford Bridge

Connect last week in one sentence before you open the book: “Harold is king. Now trouble comes from the north.” Then read. Do not lecture 1066.

What the child needs to hold, in their own words:

- Who came to fight Harold (his brother Tostig and a king from Norway).
- Harold marched north, fast.
- There was a fight at a bridge.
- Then news from the south: another enemy had landed.

Stop here. Do not read chapter 24, “The Battle of Hastings.” That is next week. If the chapter runs long, stop at twenty minutes even mid-page and finish Thursday before Little Duke — still do not start Hastings.

Timeline: write or place “Stamford Bridge, 1066.” Map, if you have one: York, the Humber, the North Sea. William’s ships wait until Friday’s map or next week. Archive.org: *An island story* (Stokes, 1906).

“The Cupboard”

From *Peacock Pie*, 1913. Both children. Read it once after they have run around. It is domestic and funny after a battle. That is the variety. No talk unless they start it. Copywork all week is the first line: *I know a little cupboard*. Gutenberg 3753.

Nature sit — Lost Pines heat

Eight o’clock, not later. One invertebrate or one web. Orb webs show in morning light between yaupon or porch rails. Cicada shells still cling to loblolly bark. Ants on the path. Look. The drawing waits for Saturday. Watch for fire ants; do not stand in them.

Preschooler: nature, Bible (as they will sit), hymn, poem. Quiet work through Ray’s and copywork. They may listen to Island Story if they will be still; they need not narrate it.

Bible · Exodus 4

King James Version. Project Gutenberg eBook #10. Public domain.

1 And Moses answered and said, But, behold, they will not believe me, nor hearken unto my voice: for they will say, The LORD hath not appeared unto thee. 2 And the LORD said unto him, What is that in thine hand? And he said, A rod. 3 And he said, Cast it on the ground. And he cast it on the ground, and it became a serpent; and Moses fled from before it. 4 And the LORD said unto Moses, Put forth thine hand, and take it by the tail. And he put forth his hand, and caught it, and it became a rod in his hand: 5 That they may believe that the LORD God of their fathers, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob, hath appeared unto thee. 6 And the LORD said furthermore unto him, Put now thine hand into thy bosom. And he put his hand into his bosom: and when he took it out, behold, his hand was leprous as snow. 7 And he said, Put thine hand into thy bosom again. And he put his hand into his bosom again; and plucked it out of his bosom, and, behold, it was turned again as his other flesh. 8 And it shall come to pass, if they will not believe thee, neither hearken to the voice of the first sign, that they will believe the voice of the latter sign. 9 And it shall come to pass, if they will not believe also these two signs, neither hearken unto thy voice, that thou shalt take of the water of the river, and pour it upon the dry land: and the water which thou takest out of the river shall become blood upon the dry land. 10 And Moses said unto the LORD, O my LORD, I am not eloquent, neither heretofore, nor since thou hast spoken unto thy servant: but I am slow of speech, and of a slow tongue. 11 And the LORD said unto him, Who hath made man's mouth? or who maketh the dumb, or deaf, or the seeing, or the blind? have not I the LORD? 12 Now therefore go, and I will be with thy mouth, and teach thee what thou shalt say. 13 And he said, O my LORD, send, I pray thee, by the hand of him whom thou wilt send. 14 And the anger of the LORD was kindled against Moses, and he said, Is not Aaron the Levite thy brother? I know that he can speak well. And also, behold, he cometh forth to meet thee: and when he seeth thee, he will be glad in his heart. 15 And thou shalt speak unto him, and put words in his mouth: and I will be with thy mouth, and with his mouth, and will teach you what ye shall do. 16 And he shall be thy spokesman unto the people: and he shall be, even he shall be to thee instead of a mouth, and thou shalt be to him instead of God. 17 And thou shalt take this rod in thine hand, wherewith thou shalt do signs. 18 And Moses went and returned to Jethro his father in law, and said unto him, Let me go, I pray thee, and return unto my brethren which are in Egypt, and see whether they be yet alive. And Jethro said to Moses, Go in peace. 19 And the LORD said unto Moses in Midian, Go, return into Egypt: for all the men are dead which sought thy life. 20 And Moses took his wife and his sons, and set them upon an ass, and he returned to the land of Egypt: and Moses took the rod of God in his hand. 21 And the LORD said unto Moses, When thou goest to return into Egypt, see that thou do all those wonders before Pharaoh, which I have put in thine hand: but I will harden his heart, that he shall not let the people go. 22 And thou shalt say unto Pharaoh, Thus saith the LORD, Israel is my son, even my firstborn: 23 And I say unto thee, Let my son go, that he may serve me: and if thou refuse to let him go, behold, I will slay thy son, even thy firstborn. 24 And it came to pass by the way in the inn, that the LORD met him, and sought to kill him. 25 Then Zipporah took a sharp stone, and cut off the foreskin of her son, and cast it at his feet, and said, Surely a bloody husband art thou to me. 26 So he let him go: then she said, A bloody husband thou art, because of the circumcision. 27 And the LORD said to Aaron, Go into the wilderness to meet Moses. And he went, and met him in the mount of God, and kissed him. 28 And Moses told Aaron all the words of the LORD who had sent him, and all the signs which he had commanded him. 29 And Moses and Aaron went and gathered together all the elders of the children of Israel: 30 And Aaron spake all the words which the LORD had spoken unto Moses, and did the signs in the sight of the people. 31 And the people believed: and when they heard that the LORD had visited the children of Israel, and that he had looked upon their affliction, then they bowed their heads and worshipped.

Our Island Story · Chapter 23 · The Battle of Stamford Bridge

H. E. Marshall, An Island Story / Our Island Story. Stokes 1906 / Jack 1905 public-domain edition (Heritage History transcription). Full chapter. Do not start Hastings (ch. 24).

Meanwhile Harold was ruling England quietly and well. The people loved him, and were glad they had chosen such a brave and generous man to rule over them. Harold was kind to every one, but he was specially kind to Edgar Ætheling. He knew that it would have been a very bad thing for England had the people chosen an ignorant little boy as king. Yet he felt sorry for Edgar, and tried to make him grow into a brave and honest English boy.

Harold kept the good laws which had been made before the time of Edward, and altered the unjust ones. He was always thinking of the happiness of his people and the good of his country. Often and often he looked anxiously across the blue sea to the shores of France, watching for the white sails of Duke William's ships.

Months passed, and still they did not appear. But Harold knew that one day they would come although William sent no more messages. Harold's friends crossed the sea to find out what the great duke was doing. They brought back news of the mighty army which was gathering on the shores of the river Dive. So Harold watched and waited, and he too gathered together men and horses, swords and armour.

Often King Harold sighed to see that there were no strong castles and fortresses to guard the shores of his dear land. For Edward, instead of building ships and castles to keep the country safe from enemies, had spent his people's money in building great churches, and in buying the bones of holy men who had lived and died long, long ago. These bones, he foolishly thought, would keep wicked men away from his shores.

One day while Harold watched and waited for the coming of William, a messenger all breathless arrived from the north. He was covered with dust and worn and tired with long travelling. He burst into the room, where the King sat, and threw himself on his knees. 'My lord and King,' he cried, 'Tostig, thy brother, and Harold Hardrada, King of Norway, have landed in the north with a mighty army of heathen folk. They have defeated Earl Morcar. They have taken York. They slay and burn without mercy. Through fear, many of thy subjects have joined the banner of Tostig. Now they are making ready to march south to take London, and Harold Hardrada of Norway will be master of all England.'

Then the messenger was silent, fainting for weariness and lack of food.

This news made Harold very sorry. Tostig was his brother, and he did not wish to fight against his own brother, but for the sake of England he knew he must. For Harold loved England better than all the world. It is said that, after he was dead, people found the word 'England' printed on his breast just over his heart, but whether that is true or not, this is true, that Harold held England in his heart and in his thoughts, and always tried to do what was best for his country.

So now Harold gathered all his own soldiers or huscarles as they were called, and set out for Yorkshire to meet the enemy.

At this time England had not a great army, as it has now, ready at all times for battle. The king only kept a few soldiers always near him. They were called his 'huscarles' or his 'body guard,' as their duty was to guard his house when he was at home and his person wherever he went.

The rest of the soldiers were the servants of the great nobles and rich merchants. Whenever the king had need of them, he used to call them together, and when the fighting was over they went back again to their own homes, and to their own masters.

Harold had called these men together to be ready for William, but as months passed and the dreadful duke did not come, they grew tired of waiting and went home. For by this time it was autumn, the fields were yellow with the ripe grain, and the orchards were laden with fruit, so the men who had come to fight went home again to gather the fruit and cut the corn before the winter set in.

But hardly had they gone, when the messenger came with the terrible news from Yorkshire.

Harold did not stop to gather his army together again, but set out as quickly as he could with the few soldiers he had.

As he rode northward, he looked back with many a sigh. He looked across the blue waters which separated him from Duke William, straining his eyes anxiously, but there was no sign of a sail. 'Please God,' he murmured, 'I may yet return in time to meet the Norman wolf.'

In those days, the roads were very bad. Some of them were only tracks worn by the feet of horses. There was no means, either, of going from place to place, except by walking or riding. But there was one great road, which the Romans had made long, long before. This stretched all the way from York to London. Harold was so clever that in a few days he brought his little army along this road from the very south to the middle of England. By 24th September he had arrived at York. On the 25th a great battle was fought at a place near there, called Stamford Bridge. In memory of that great fight it was afterwards called Battle Bridge.

Before the fighting began, the two armies stood facing each other.

Up and down the lines of the Norwegian army rode a very tall man on a lovely black horse. He was dressed in splendid steel armour, and a beautiful blue cloak hung from his shoulders. As he rode, his horse stumbled and fell, and the tall man was thrown to the ground. He sprang up again with a laugh. 'Oh!' he said, 'a fall means good luck to a traveller.'

But Harold, who had been watching, turned to some one beside him. 'Who is that tall man with the blue cloak and beautiful helmet?' he asked.

'That is Harold Hardrada, King of Norway,' was the reply.

'He has had a fall,' said Harold of England. 'That means bad luck to him.'

One side, you see, thought it was good luck, and the other thought it was bad, although really, of course, it made no difference one way or another. But, in those days, people were very superstitious, that is, they found a meaning in things that had no meaning at all.

Harold of England looked sadly along the lines of the army opposite. He was looking for the banner of his brother Tostig. When he saw it he rode, almost alone, right up to the Norwegian army. His men looked on in surprise and fear as he rode so near the enemy, attended only by a few knights. When he was quite close to them, he stopped his horse, and called out, 'Is Earl Tostig, son of Godwin, in this army?'

Tostig himself answered, 'Yes, what want you with him?' and he rode out to meet the king.

Although Tostig's face was hidden by his helmet, King Harold knew his brother's voice. So his tone was kind and gentle, as he answered: 'Your brother, King Harold, sends you greeting. He does not wish to fight against you. If you will send away these soldiers, he will forgive you all the wrong you have done, and he will give you the earldom of Northumbria once more.'

'And if I accept his offer,' said Tostig, 'what will he give to my friend Harold Hardrada?'

King Harold's voice grew stern as he answered, 'He shall have seven feet of English ground for a grave, or a little more perhaps, as he is so much taller than other men.'

'Then,' said the earl, 'go and tell King Harold to get ready for battle, for it shall never be said that Tostig brought his friend to England to betray him.'

Then the brothers parted, sad and angry, each riding back to his own side.

'Who was that fine man with whom you have been speaking?' asked Harold Hardrada, as Tostig came back.

'That is King Harold of England,' replied the earl.

'Why did you not tell me?' said the king. 'He was so near! So near death, for had I known who he was, he would never have gone back to his own people.'

But although Tostig was a wild, wicked man, he was not altogether bad. He looked sadly at King Harold Hardrada and said, 'He came to offer me peace and forgiveness. He is my brother, though my enemy. Had I betrayed him to you, I should have been not only his foe, but his murderer.'

Then it seemed as if Harold Hardrada was ashamed.

Soon the battle began. Harold Hardrada rode in front singing a loud battle song.

Advance! Advance! No helmets glance, But blue swords play In our array. Advance! Advance! No mail coats glance But hearts are here That ne'er knew fear.

He sang that because these Northmen, as they were called, often fought in their shirts and wore no armour or protection of any kind. So they got the name of 'Berserkers,' and in Scotland to this day the word 'sark' is used to mean shirt.

The fight was fierce and long. Sometimes it seemed as if the English would win, sometimes the Northmen. In the very thickest of the fight rode the two kings, each cheering on his men.

When battle storm was ringing, Where arrow cloud was singing, Harold stood there, Of armour bare, His deadly sword still swinging. The foemen felt its bite; His horsemen rush to fight, Danger to share With Harold there, Where steel on steel was ringing.

But at last both Earl Tostig and King Harold Hardrada were killed, and their soldiers fled in all directions.

King Harold of England was very kind to those who were not killed. He did not take them prisoners, but allowed them to go away with their ships to their own country, having first made them promise never to fight against England again.

Stop here. Do not read chapter 24, "The Battle of Hastings." That is next week.

The Cupboard

Walter de la Mare, Peacock Pie: A Book of Rhymes (1913). Project Gutenberg eBook #3753. Poem in full.

*I know a little cupboard,
With a teeny tiny key,
And there's a jar of Lollypops
For me, me, me.*

*It has a little shelf, my dear,
As dark as dark can be,
And there's a dish of Banbury Cakes
For me, me, me.*

*I have a small fat grandmamma,
With a very slippery knee,
And she's the Keeper of the Cupboard
With the key, key, key.*

*And I'm very good, my dear,
As good as good can be,
There's Branbury Cakes, and Lollypops
For me, me, me.*

DAY TWO

SEPTEMBER 17, 2026

Thursday

HAVE READY

Bible · folk song (previewed) · Ray's · *The Little Duke* · *Burgess Animal Book* ch. 2

8:00

Short yard time OPTIONAL

Ten minutes if Wednesday's sit went well. Or skip and save the long walk for Saturday evening.

8:20

Bible · Exodus 5 PRESCHOOLER JOINS

Bricks without straw. Pharaoh will not let them go; the work gets harder. Read once. Narrate. Do not turn it into a lecture. The preschooler will hold "more bricks"; the 2nd grader should hold the whole thread.

8:35

Folk song

“The Bold Grenadier,” also sung as “One Morning in May.” Preview the lyrics first. Some old verses are not for children. Sing a clean set. Both children.

8:45

Ray’s, copywork, recitation

Next Ray’s lesson. Copywork: *I know a little cupboard*. Recitation: Genesis 1:1. If the verse is sticking, add the first two lines of “The Cupboard” at the end of the morning.

9:20

Tales · *The Little Duke*, ch. 1 second half

Week 1 stopped after the boy and the castle. This sitting: Duke William’s visit, the talk about reading and forgiving enemies, the silver key, father rides away. Finish the chapter. Do not start chapter 2. Narrate. Gutenberg 3048.

9:50

Natural history · Burgess ch. 2 PRESCHOOLER JOINS

“Peter and Jumper Go To School.” Both children. The easy living-science of the week. Narrate one true difference between Peter and Jumper.

10:10

Done

Books finished. If anyone is still bright, reread “The Cupboard.” Do not add another chapter.

If you must cut: keep Bible, Ray’s, Little Duke, and Burgess. Folk song can wait for Saturday.

How to teach Thursday

Finish a chapter. Start a school in the Green Forest. Do not open the next door.

Exodus 5 — bricks without straw

Moses and Aaron go to Pharaoh. The answer is more work, not less. The people turn on Moses. Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. This is a hard chapter. You do not need to explain providence. One true sentence if the child is distressed: the story is not over. Then stop.

Little Duke — second half of chapter 1

Open where you marked last week. If you are not sure, the second half is the father's visit: the feast, the private talk (letters, English kings, forgiving enemies), the silver key on a chain, then morning and Duke William riding away.

Stop at the end of chapter 1. Do not start chapter 2. The messengers, and what they bring, belong to next week. If they beg, say the next part keeps. That is the method.

Narration: what Richard and his father talked about, and how the visit ended. If they only remember the hunt or the key, that is still a narration. Do not prompt the forgiveness talk unless they found it themselves. Gutenberg 3048.

Burgess ch. 2 — Peter and Jumper go to school

Old Mother Nature asks Peter what he looks like, where he lives, what he eats. Then Jumper. Snowshoe feet. A cousin in the south who likes water. Both children sit for this. It is the living science, not a textbook.

Narrate one true difference between Peter and Jumper (ears, feet, winter coat, holes in the ground). If they also remember the swimming cousin, good. No chart. No "rodent" lecture — that comes later in the book and is not this week's work. Gutenberg 2441.

Folk song

Same clean set as last week. Preview again if you switched recordings. Five minutes. Both children. If anyone is wriggly after Exodus, sing before math, as written.

Preschooler: Bible as they will sit, folk song, Burgess. Quiet work through Ray's, copywork, and Little Duke. Little Duke is a tale, so they may listen if they will be still; they need not narrate Richard's talk with his father.

Bible · Exodus 5

King James Version. Project Gutenberg eBook #10. Public domain.

1 And afterward Moses and Aaron went in, and told Pharaoh, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, Let my people go, that they may hold a feast unto me in the wilderness. 2 And Pharaoh said, Who is the LORD, that I should obey his voice to let Israel go? I know not the LORD, neither will I let Israel go. 3 And they said, The God of the Hebrews hath met with us: let us go, we pray thee, three days' journey into the desert, and sacrifice unto the LORD our God; lest he fall upon us with pestilence, or with the sword. 4 And the king of Egypt said unto them, Wherefore do ye, Moses and Aaron, let the people from their works? get you unto your burdens. 5 And Pharaoh said, Behold, the people of the land now are many, and ye make them rest from their burdens. 6 And Pharaoh commanded the same day the taskmasters of the people, and their officers, saying, 7 Ye shall no more give the people straw to make brick, as heretofore: let them go and gather straw for themselves. 8 And the tale of the bricks, which they did make heretofore, ye shall lay upon them; ye shall not diminish ought thereof: for they be idle; therefore they cry, saying, Let us go and sacrifice to our God. 9 Let there more work be laid upon the men, that they may labour therein; and let them not regard vain words. 10 And the taskmasters of the people went out, and their officers, and they spake to the people, saying, Thus saith Pharaoh, I will not give you straw. 11 Go ye, get you straw where ye can find it: yet not ought of your work shall be diminished. 12 So the people were scattered abroad throughout all the land of Egypt to gather stubble instead of straw. 13 And the taskmasters hasted them, saying, Fulfil your works, your daily tasks, as when there was straw. 14 And the officers of the children of Israel, which Pharaoh's taskmasters had set over them, were beaten, and demanded, Wherefore have ye not fulfilled your task in making brick both yesterday and to day, as heretofore? 15 Then the officers of the children of Israel came and cried unto Pharaoh, saying, Wherefore dealest thou thus with thy servants? 16 There is no straw given unto thy servants, and they say to us, Make brick: and, behold, thy servants are beaten; but the fault is in thine own people. 17 But he said, Ye are idle, ye are idle: therefore ye say, Let us go and do sacrifice to the LORD. 18 Go therefore now, and work; for there shall no straw be given you, yet shall ye deliver the tale of bricks. 19 And the officers of the children of Israel did see that they were in evil case, after it was said, Ye shall not minish ought from your bricks of your daily task. 20 And they met Moses and Aaron, who stood in the way, as they came forth from Pharaoh: 21 And they said unto them, The LORD look upon you, and judge; because ye have made our savour to be abhorred in the eyes of Pharaoh, and in the eyes of his servants, to put a sword in their hand to slay us. 22 And Moses returned unto the LORD, and said, LORD, wherefore hast thou so evil entreated this people? why is it that thou hast sent me? 23 For since I came to Pharaoh to speak in thy name, he hath done evil to this people; neither hast thou delivered thy people at all.

The Little Duke · Chapter 1, remainder

Charlotte M. Yonge, The Little Duke. Macmillan 1905. Gutenberg #3048. Public domain. This sitting: the feast, the talk (letters, English kings, forgiving enemies), the silver key, father rides away. Does not repeat week 1's first half. Does not open chapter 2.

It would take too long to tell all the friendly and courteous words that were spoken, the greeting of the Duke and the noble old Lady Astrida, and the reception of the Barons who had come in the train of their Lord. Richard was bidden to greet them, but, though he held out his hand as desired, he shrank a little to his father's side, gazing at them in dread and shyness.

There was Count Bernard, of Harcourt, called the "Dane," with his shaggy red hair and beard, to which a touch of grey had given a strange unnatural tint, his eyes looking fierce and wild under his thick eyebrows, one of them misshapen in consequence of a sword cut, which had left a broad red and purple scar across both cheek and forehead. There, too, came tall Baron Rainulf, of Ferrieres, cased in a linked steel hauberk, that rang as he walked, and the men-at-arms, with helmets and shields, looking as if Sir Eric's armour that hung in the hail had come to life and was walking about.

They sat down to Fru Astrida's banquet, the old Lady at the Duke's right hand, and the Count of Harcourt on his left; Osmond carved for the Duke, and Richard handed his cup and trencher. All through the meal, the Duke and his Lords talked earnestly of the expedition on which they were bound to meet Count Arnulf of Flanders, on a little islet in the river Somme, there to come to some agreement, by which Arnulf might make restitution to Count Herluin of Montreuil, for certain wrongs which he had done him.

Some said that this would be the fittest time for requiring Arnulf to yield up some towns on his borders, to which Normandy had long laid claim, but the Duke shook his head, saying that he must seek no selfish advantage, when called to judge between others.

Richard was rather tired of their grave talk, and thought the supper very long; but at last it was over, the Grace was said, the boards which had served for tables were removed, and as it was still light, some of the guests went to see how their steeds had been bestowed, others to look at Sir Eric's horses and hounds, and others collected together in groups.

The Duke had time to attend to his little boy, and Richard sat upon his knee and talked, told about all his pleasures, how his arrow had hit the deer to-day, how Sir Eric let him ride out to the chase on his little pony, how Osmond would take him to bathe in the cool bright river, and how he had watched the raven's nest in the top of the old tower.

Duke William listened, and smiled, and seemed as well pleased to hear as the boy was to tell. "And, Richard," said he at last, "have you nought to tell me of Father Lucas, and his great book? What, not a word? Look up, Richard, and tell me how it goes with the learning."

"Oh, father!" said Richard, in a low voice, playing with the clasp of his father's belt, and looking down, "I don't like those crabbed letters on the old yellow parchment."

"But you try to learn them, I hope!" said the Duke.

"Yes, father, I do, but they are very hard, and the words are so long, and Father Lucas will always come when the sun is so bright, and the wood so green, that I know not how to bear to be kept poring over those black hooks and strokes."

"Poor little fellow," said Duke William, smiling and Richard, rather encouraged, went on more boldly. "You do not know this reading, noble father?"

"To my sorrow, no," said the Duke.

"And Sir Eric cannot read, nor Osmond, nor any one, and why must I read, and cramp my fingers with writing, just as if I was a clerk, instead of a young Duke?" Richard looked up in his father's face, and then hung his head, as if half-ashamed of questioning his will, but the Duke answered him without displeasure.

"It is hard, no doubt, my boy, to you now, but it will be the better for you in the end. I would give much to be able myself to read those holy books which I must now only hear read to me by a clerk, but since I have had the wish, I have had no time to learn as you have now."

"But Knights and Nobles never learn," said Richard.

"And do you think it a reason they never should? But you are wrong, my boy, for the Kings of France and England, the Counts of Anjou, of Provence, and Paris, yes, even King Hako of Norway, can all read."

"I tell you, Richard, when the treaty was drawn up for restoring this King Louis to his throne, I was ashamed to find myself one of the few crown vassals who could not write his name thereto."

"But none is so wise or so good as you, father," said Richard, proudly. "Sir Eric often says so."

"Sir Eric loves his Duke too well to see his faults," said Duke William; "but far better and wiser might I have been, had I been taught by such masters as you may be. And hark, Richard, not only can all Princes here read, but in England, King Ethelstane would have every Noble taught; they study in his own palace, with his brothers, and read the good words that King Alfred the truth-teller put into their own tongue for them."

"I hate the English," said Richard, raising his head and looking very fierce.

"Hate them? and wherefore?"

"Because they traitorously killed the brave Sea King Ragnar! Fru Astrida sings his death-song, which he chanted when the vipers were gnawing him to death, and he gloried to think how his sons would bring the ravens to feast upon the Saxon. Oh! had I been his son, how I would have carried on the feud! How I would have laughed when I cut down the false traitors, and burnt their palaces!" Richard's eye kindled, and his words, as he spoke the old Norse language, flowed into the sort of wild verse in which the Sagas or legendary songs were composed, and which, perhaps, he was unconsciously repeating.

Duke William looked grave.

"Fru Astrida must sing you no more such Sagas," said he, "if they fill your mind with these revengeful thoughts, fit only for the worshippers of Odin and Thor. Neither Ragnar nor his sons knew better than to rejoice in this deadly vengeance, but we, who are Christians, know that it is for us to forgive."

"The English had slain their father!" said Richard, looking up with wondering dissatisfied eyes.

"Yes, Richard, and I speak not against them, for they were even as we should have been, had not King Harold the fair-haired driven your grandfather from Denmark. They had not been taught the truth, but to us it has been said, 'Forgive, and ye shall be forgiven.' Listen to me, my son, Christian as is this nation of ours, this duty of forgiveness is too often neglected, but let it not be so with you. Bear in mind, whenever you see the Cross marked on our banner, or carved in stone on the Churches, that it speaks of forgiveness to us; but of that pardon we shall never taste if we forgive not our enemies. Do you mark me, boy?"

Richard hesitated a little, and then said, "Yes, father, but I could never have pardoned, had I been one of Ragnar's sons."

"It may be that you will be in their case, Richard," said the Duke, "and should I fall, as it may well be I shall, in some of the contests that tear to pieces this unhappy Kingdom of France, then, remember what I say now. I charge you, on your duty to God and to your father, that you keep up no feud, no hatred, but rather that you should deem me best revenged, when you have with heart and hand, given the fullest proof of forgiveness to your enemy. Give me your word that you will."

"Yes, father," said Richard, with rather a subdued tone, and resting his head on his father's shoulder. There was a silence for a little space, during which he began to revive into playfulness, to stroke the Duke's short curled beard, and play with his embroidered collar.

In so doing, his fingers caught hold of a silver chain, and pulling it out with a jerk, he saw a silver key attached to it. "Oh, what is that?" he asked eagerly. "What does that key unlock?"

"My greatest treasure," replied Duke William, as he replaced the chain and key within his robe.

"Your greatest treasure, father! Is that your coronet?"

"You will know one day," said his father, putting the little hand down from its too busy investigations; and some of the Barons at that moment returning into the hall, he had no more leisure to bestow on his little son.

The next day, after morning service in the Chapel, and breakfast in the hall, the Duke again set forward on his journey, giving Richard hopes he might return in a fortnight's time, and obtaining from him a promise that he would be very attentive to Father Lucas, and very obedient to Sir Eric de Centeville.

Stop at the end of chapter 1. Do not start chapter 2. The messengers belong to next week.

The Burgess Animal Book · Chapter 2

Thornton W. Burgess, The Burgess Animal Book for Children (1920). Gutenberg #2441. Chapter II, "Peter and Jumper Go To School," in full.

Hardly had jolly, round, red Mr. Sun thrown off his rosy blankets and begun his daily climb up in the blue, blue sky when Peter Rabbit and his cousin, Jumper the Hare, arrived at the place in the Green Forest where Peter had found Old Mother Nature the day before. She was waiting for them, ready to begin the first lesson.

"I am glad you are so prompt," said she. "Promptness is one of the most important things in life. Now I am very, very busy these days, as you know, so we will begin school at once. Before either of you ask any questions, I am going to ask some myself. Peter, what do you look like? Where do you live? What do you eat? I want to find out just how much you really know about yourself."

Peter scratched one ear with a long hind foot and hesitated as if he didn't know just how to begin. Old Mother Nature waited patiently. Finally Peter began rather timidly.

"Of course," said he, "the only way I know how I look is by the way the other members of my family look, for I've never seen myself. I suppose in a way I look like all the rest of the Rabbit family. I have long hind legs and short front ones. I suppose this is so I can make long jumps when I am in a hurry."

Old Mother Nature nodded, and Peter, taking courage, continued. "My hind legs are stout and strong, but my front ones are rather weak. I guess this is because I do not have a great deal of use for them, except for running. My coat is a sort of mixture of brown and gray, more brown in summer and more gray in winter. My ears are longer for my size than are those of most animals, but really not very long after all, not nearly as long for my size as my cousin Jumper's are for his size. My tail doesn't amount to much because it is so short that it is hardly worth calling a tail. It is so short I carry it straight up. It is white like a little bunch of cotton, and I suppose that that is why I am called a Cottontail Rabbit, though I have heard that some folks call me a Gray Rabbit and others a Bush Rabbit. I guess I'm called Bush Rabbit because I like bushy country in which to live."

"I live in the dear Old Briar-patch and just love it. It is a mass of bushes and bramble-tangles and is the safest place I know of. I have cut little paths all through it just big enough for Mrs. Peter and myself. None of our enemies can get at us there, excepting Shadow the Weasel or Billy Mink. I have a sort of nest there where I spend my time when I am not running about. It is called a form and I sit in it a great deal."

"In summer I eat clover, grass and other green things, and I just love to get over into Farmer Brown's garden. In winter I have to take what I can get, and this is mostly bark from young trees, buds and tender twigs of bushes, and any green plants I can find under the snow. I can run fast for a short distance, but only for a short distance. That is why I like thick brush and bramble-tangles. There I can dodge. I don't know any one who can beat me at dodging. If Reddy Fox or Bowser the Hound surprises me away from the dear Old Briar-patch I run for the nearest hollow log or hole in the ground. Sometimes in summer I dig a hole for myself, but not often. It is much easier to use a hole somebody else has dug. When I want to signal my friends I thump the ground with my hind feet. Jumper does the same thing. I forgot to say I don't like water."

Old Mother Nature smiled. "You are thinking of that cousin of yours, the Marsh Rabbit who lives way down in the Sunny South," said she.

Peter looked a wee bit foolish and admitted that he was. Jumper the Hare was all interest at once. You see, he had never heard of this cousin.

"That was a very good account of yourself, Peter," said Old Mother Nature. "Now take a look at your cousin, Jumper the Hare, and tell me how he differs from you."

Peter took a long look at Jumper, and then, as before, scratched one ear with a long hind foot. "In the first place," said he, "Jumper is considerably bigger than I. He has very long hind legs and his ears are very long. In summer he wears a brown coat, but in winter he is all white but the tips of those long ears, and those are black. Because his coat changes so, he is called the varying Hare. He likes the Green Forest where the trees grow close together, especially those places where there are a great many young trees. He's the biggest member of our family. I guess that's all I know about Cousin Jumper."

"That is very good, Peter, as far as it goes," said Old Mother Nature. "You have made only one mistake. Jumper is not the biggest of his family."

Both Peter and Jumper opened their eyes very wide with surprise. "Also," continued Old Mother Nature, "you forgot to mention the fact that Jumper never hides in hollow logs and holes in the ground as you do. Why don't you, Jumper?"

"I wouldn't feel safe there," replied Jumper rather timidly. "I depend on my long legs for safety, and the way I can dodge around trees and bushes. I suppose Reddy Fox may be fast enough to catch me in the open, but he can't do it where I can dodge around trees and bushes. That is why I stick to the Green Forest. If you please, Mother Nature, what is this about a cousin who likes to swim?"

Old Mother Nature's eyes twinkled. "We'll get to that later on," said she. "Now, each of you hold up a hind foot and tell me what difference you see."

Peter and Jumper each held up a hind foot and each looked first at his own and then at the other's. "They look to me very much alike, only Jumper's is a lot longer and bigger than mine," said Peter. Jumper nodded as if he agreed.

"What's the matter with your eyes?" demanded Old Mother Nature. "Don't you see that Jumper's foot is a great deal broader than yours, Peter, and that his toes are spread apart, while yours are close together?"

Peter and Jumper looked sheepish, for it was just as Old Mother Nature had said. Jumper's foot really was quite different from that of Peter. Peter's was narrow and slim.

"That is a very important difference," declared Old Mother Nature. "Can you guess why I gave you those big feet, Jumper?"

Jumper slowly shook his head. "Not unless it was to make me different," said he.

"I'm surprised," said Old Mother Nature. "Yes, indeed, I'm surprised. You ought to know by this time that I never give anybody anything without a purpose. What happens to those big feet of yours in the winter, Jumper?"

"Nothing that I know of, excepting that the hair grows out long between my toes," Jumper replied.

"Exactly," snapped Old Mother Nature. "And when the hair does this you can travel over light snow without sinking in. It is just as if you had snowshoes. That is why you are often called a Snowshoe Rabbit. I gave you those big feet and make the hair grow out every winter because I know that you depend on your legs to get away from your enemies. You can run over the deep snow where your enemies break through. Peter, though he is small and lighter than you are, cannot go where you can. But Peter doesn't need to depend always on his legs to save his life. There is one thing more that I want you both to notice, and that is that you both have quite a lot of short hairs on the soles of your feet. That is where you differ from that cousin of yours down in the Sunny South. He has only a very few hairs on his feet. That is so he can swim better."

"If you please, Mother Nature, why is that cousin of ours so fond of the water?" piped up Peter.

"Because," replied Old Mother Nature, "he lives in marshy country where there is a great deal of water. He is very nearly the same size as you, Peter, and looks very much like you. But his legs are not quite so long, his ears are a little smaller, and his tail is brownish instead of white. He is a poor runner and so in time of danger he takes to the water. For that matter, he goes swimming for pleasure. The water is warm down there, and he dearly loves to paddle about in it. If a Fox chases him he simply plunges into the water and hides among the water plants with only his eyes and his nose out of water."

“Does he make his home in the water like Jerry Muskrat?” asked Peter innocently.

Mother Nature smiled and shook her head. “Certainly not,” she replied. “His home is on the ground. His babies are born in a nest made just as Mrs. Peter makes her nest for your babies, and Mrs. Jumper makes a nest for Jumper's babies. It is made of grass and lined with soft fur which Mrs. Rabbit pulls from her own breast, and it is very carefully hidden. By the way, Peter how do your babies differ from the babies of your Cousin Jumper?”

Peter shook his head. “I don't know,” said he. “My babies don't have their eyes open when they are born, and they haven't any hair.”

Jumper pricked up his long ears. “What's that?” said he. “Why, my babies have their eyes open and have the dearest little fur coats!”

Old Mother Nature chuckled. “That is the difference,” said she. “I guess both of you have learned something.”

“You said a little while ago that Jumper isn't the biggest of our family,” said Peter. “If you please, who is?”

“There are several bigger than Jumper,” replied Old Mother Nature, and smiled as she saw the funny look of surprise on the faces of Peter and Jumper. “There is one way up the Frozen North and there are two cousins way out in the Great West. They are as much bigger than Jumper as Jumper is bigger than you, Peter. But I haven't time to tell you about them now. If you really want to learn about them, be here promptly at sun-up to-morrow morning. Hello! Here comes Reddy Fox, and he looks to me as if a good breakfast would not come amiss. Let me see what you have learned about taking care of yourselves.”

Peter and Jumper gave one startled look in the direction Mother Nature was pointing. Sure enough, there was Reddy Fox. Not far away was a hollow log. Peter wasted no time in getting to it. In fact, he left in such a hurry that he forgot to say good-by to Old Mother Nature. But she didn't mind, for she quite understood Peter's feelings, and she laughed when she saw his funny little white tail disappear inside the hollow log. As for Jumper, he promptly took to his long legs and disappeared with great bounds, Reddy Fox racing after him.

DAY THREE · FIRST WORLD-HISTORY SITTING

SEPTEMBER 18, 2026

Friday

HAVE READY

Bible · hymn · Ray's · Hillyer (or Synge) · cheap compass · simple map of England and western Europe · Rockwell, *Freedom of Speech*

8:20

Bible · Exodus 6

God repeats the promise. Moses is still discouraged. **Omit verses 14–25** (the family list). Read once. Narrate. You do not need to unpack every name of God today.

8:35

Hymn, Ray's, copywork, recitation

Same stanza as Wednesday. Next Ray's lesson. Copywork: the cupboard line. Recitation: Genesis 1:1. Preschooler: quiet work through math and copywork, then they may come for map and picture study.

9:20

World history · CHOW, Charlemagne

Later printings: ch. 47 “Two Empires, Two Emperors.” 1924 Gutenberg: ch. 45 “A Light in the Dark Ages.” Same sitting. Two emperors, about the year 800. Cap at 20 minutes. Narrate who Charlemagne

was. This is not England. Do not mash it into Stamford Bridge.

9:50

Map, then compass PRESCHOOLER JOINS

Point: York and the North Sea (Wednesday’s battle). Point: France or Aachen (Charlemagne). Then the compass. Hide it. Let the 2nd grader find north. Preschooler plays “find north.” No worksheet.

10:10

Picture study · Rockwell, *Freedom of Speech*

Second look at the same painting. Look four minutes in silence. Turn it over. Child tells what was there, then one new thing they did not say last week. Look once more. Library book or a museum image on a screen. Do not print a packet.

If you must cut: keep Bible, Ray’s, CHOW, and picture study. Map can be a five-minute point-and-name after CHOW.

How to teach Friday

A new history book. Match the chapter to the copy in your hand. Then look at the painting again.

Exodus 6 — skip the names

Read 6:1–13, skip 14–25, finish the chapter if you want the last promises. The middle is a genealogy. AO says you may omit it. Omit it. Narrate: God tells Moses again that He will bring the people out; Moses still does not see how. One sentence, then stop.

Which CHOW chapter?

AO's week 2 line is: *Child's History of the World* ch. 47 "Two Empires, Two Emperors" (ch. 45 "Light in the Dark Ages" in 1st ed.).

- If your book's contents list **Two Empires, Two Emperors** as chapter 47, read that.
- If you are on Gutenberg 67149 or another 1924 text, read **chapter 45, "A Light in the Dark Ages."**
- If you do not have Hillyer, AO's other options are Synge, *Discovery of New Worlds* ch. 12 "The Dark Ages," or van Loon ch. 29 Charlemagne. One of these, not all of them.

The sitting is Charlemagne and two empires, about the year 800. Read once. Cap at 20 minutes. Narrate who Charlemagne was, and what "two emperors" means in the child's words. Timeline: "Charlemagne, about 800." That is more than a hundred years before Harold. Say so once, on the timeline, not as a quiz.

Do not mash this into Wednesday. Stamford Bridge is England, 1066. CHOW today is the continent, about 800. Two pictures, two days.

1924 text: Gutenberg 67149. AO chapter list: amblesideonline.org/contents-chow-sotw.

Map and compass

Term work is still the compass (needle north; N S E W; sailors). This week's stories give you two places to point before you hide the compass: York / North Sea, and France or Aachen. Then go outside if the heat allows, or stand at the door. Preschooler: "find north." No worksheet. If CHOW ran long, do only the two points on the map and skip the compass review.

Picture study — second look

Same painting as last Friday: Rockwell, *Freedom of Speech*. Look four minutes. Turn it over. They tell what they remember, then one thing they did not say last week. Look again. That is the whole lesson. No art-history talk. Copyright still holds; looking is the lesson.

Bible · Exodus 6

King James Version. Project Gutenberg eBook #10. Public domain. Verses 14–25 (the genealogy) omitted as assigned.

1 Then the LORD said unto Moses, Now shalt thou see what I will do to Pharaoh: for with a strong hand shall he let them go, and with a strong hand shall he drive them out of his land. 2 And God spake unto Moses, and said unto him, I am the LORD: 3 And I appeared unto Abraham, unto Isaac, and unto Jacob, by the name of God Almighty, but by my name JEHOVAH was I not known to them. 4 And I have also established my covenant with them, to give them the land of Canaan, the land of their pilgrimage, wherein they were strangers. 5 And I have also heard the groaning of the children of Israel, whom the Egyptians keep in bondage; and I have remembered my covenant. 6 Wherefore say unto the children of Israel, I am the LORD, and I will bring you out from under the burdens of the Egyptians, and I will rid you out of their bondage, and I will redeem you with a stretched out arm, and with great judgments: 7 And I will take you to me for a people, and I will be to you a God: and ye shall know that I am the LORD your God, which bringeth you out from under the burdens of the Egyptians. 8 And I will bring you in unto the land, concerning the which I did swear to give it to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob; and I will give it you for an heritage: I am the LORD. 9 And Moses spake so unto the children of Israel: but they hearkened not unto Moses for anguish of spirit, and for cruel bondage. 10 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying, 11 Go in, speak unto Pharaoh king of Egypt, that he let the children of Israel go out of his land. 12 And Moses spake before the LORD, saying, Behold, the children of Israel have not hearkened unto me; how then shall Pharaoh hear me, who am of uncircumcised lips? 13 And the LORD spake unto Moses and unto Aaron, and gave them a charge unto the children of Israel, and unto Pharaoh king of Egypt, to bring the children of Israel out of the land of Egypt.

[Verses 14–25, a family list, omitted as assigned.]

26 These are that Aaron and Moses, to whom the LORD said, Bring out the children of Israel from the land of Egypt according to their armies. 27 These are they which spake to Pharaoh king of Egypt, to bring out the children of Israel from Egypt: these are that Moses and Aaron. 28 And it came to pass on the day when the LORD spake unto Moses in the land of Egypt, 29 That the LORD spake unto Moses, saying, I am the LORD: speak thou unto Pharaoh king of Egypt all that I say unto thee. 30 And Moses said before the LORD, Behold, I am of uncircumcised lips, and how shall Pharaoh hearken unto me?

A Child's History of the World · Chapter 45 · A Light in the Dark Ages

V. M. Hillyer, A Child's History of the World. First edition, D. Appleton-Century, 1924. Project Gutenberg eBook #67149. Public domain. This is the 1924 numbering: ch. 45 "A Light in the Dark Ages" (later printings often number the same Charlemagne sitting as ch. 47 "Two Empires, Two Emperors"). Full chapter from the 1924 text.

Europe had been "dark" for three hundred years. You know what I mean.

There were not enough "bright" people to make it light. Ignorant Teutons had been ruling over the pieces of the old Roman Empire.

The Arabs were bright, but they were not in Europe.

But in 800 there was a very "bright light"--a man--a king--who by his might and power was able to join the pieces of Europe together once again to form a new Roman Empire. He was not a Roman, however, but a Teuton, as you can tell from his name, which was Charles. He was a grandson of that Charles the Hammer who had stopped the Moslems at Tours, and he was called by the French name Charlemagne, which means Charles the Great.

Charlemagne at first was king of France alone, but he was not satisfied to be king of that country only, and so he soon conquered the countries on each side of him, parts of Spain and Germany. Then he moved the capital of his empire from Paris to a place in Germany called Aix-la-Chapelle, which was more convenient than Paris to this larger empire, and besides at Aix-la-Chapelle there were warm springs which made fine baths, and Charlemagne was very fond of bathing and was a fine swimmer.

Italy was then ruled over by the pope. But the pope was having a good deal of trouble with some tribes in the north of Italy, and he asked Charlemagne if he wouldn't come down and conquer them. Charlemagne was quite ready and willing to help the pope, so he went over into Italy and easily settled those troublesome tribes. The pope was grateful to Charlemagne for this and wished to reward him.

Now, Christians everywhere used to make trips to Rome in order to pray at the great Church of St. Peter, which had been built over the spot where St. Peter had been crucified. Well, at Christmas-time in the Year 800 Charlemagne paid such a visit to Rome. On Christmas day he went to the Church of St. Peter and was praying at the altar when suddenly the pope came forward and put a crown on his head. The pope then hailed him "Emperor," and as the pope at that time could make kings and emperors, Charlemagne became emperor of Italy added to the other countries over which he already ruled. These countries together were really about the same as the western part of the old Roman Empire. So Charlemagne's empire was now like a new Roman Empire, but with this big difference: it was ruled over not by a Roman, but by a Teuton.

Charlemagne started out an ignorant uneducated Teuton, but he was not like most other Teutons who didn't know they were ignorant and didn't care whether they were ignorant or not. He was anxious to know everything there was to be known. He wanted to be able to do everything any one could do.

In those days when the Teutons were ruling, few people had any education, and hardly any one could read or write. Charlemagne wanted an education, but there was no one in his own country who knew enough or was able to teach him. In England, however, there was a very learned monk named Alcuin. He knew more than any one of that time, and so Charlemagne invited Alcuin to come over from England and teach him and his people. Alcuin taught Charles about the sciences; he taught him Latin and Greek poetry; he taught him the wisdom of the Greek philosophers.

Charlemagne learned all these things very easily, but when it came to the simple matter of learning to read and write he found this too hard. He did learn to read a little, but he seemed unable to learn to write. It is said that he slept with his writing-pad under his pillow and practised whenever he awoke. And yet he never learned to write anything more

than his name. He did not begin to study until he was a grown man, but he kept on studying all the rest of his life. Except for reading and writing, he became, next to his teacher, Alcuin, the best-educated man in Europe.

In spite of the fact that Charlemagne's daughters were princesses, he had them taught how to weave and sew and make clothes and cook just as if they had to earn their own living.

Although Charlemagne was such a rich and powerful monarch and could have everything he wanted, he preferred to eat plain food and dress in plain clothes. He did not like all the finery that those about him loved. One day, just to make his nobles see how ridiculously dressed they were in silks and satins, he took them out hunting in the woods while a storm was going on, so that he could laugh at them. That was his idea of a good joke. You can imagine how their silk and satin robes looked after being soaked with rain, covered with mud, and torn by briars. Charlemagne thought it was very funny.

But although his tastes were simple in matters of dress, he made his home a magnificent palace. He furnished it with gold and silver tables and chairs and other gorgeous furniture. He built in it swimming-pools and a wonderful library and a theater and surrounded it with beautiful gardens.

At this time and all through the Dark Ages people had a strange way of finding out whether a person had stolen or committed a murder or any other crime. The person suspected was not taken into court and tried before a judge and a jury to see whether he was telling the truth and had done the thing or not. Instead he was made to carry a red-hot iron for ten steps, or to dip his arm into boiling water, or to walk over red-hot coals. If he was not guilty it was thought no harm would come to him, or if he were burned it was thought that the burn would heal right away. This was called trial by ordeal. It probably started from the story told in the Bible of Shadrach, Meshech, and Abednego, who, you remember, in the time of Nebuchadnezzar, had walked through the fiery furnace unharmed because they had done no wrong. Strange to say, though Charlemagne was so intelligent, he believed in the trial by ordeal. To-day we have no such cruel and unfair way of finding out whether one is guilty or not. Yet we say of a person who has a lot of trouble that seems to be a test of his character, "He is going through an ordeal."

While Charlemagne was living, there was a caliph in far-off Bagdad named Haroun, which is the Moslem spelling of Aaron. You may have heard of him if you have read any of the "Arabian Nights," for the "Arabian Night" stories were written at this time, and Haroun is described in them. Although Haroun was a Mohammedan, not a Christian, and though he was ruler of an empire that hated the Christians, nevertheless he admired Charlemagne very much. To show how much he thought of him, he sent him valuable presents; among other things, a clock which struck the hours, which you remember, was an invention of the Arabs. This was a great curiosity, for there were then no clocks in Europe. People had to tell time by the shadow the sun cast on a sun-dial, or else by the amount of water or sand that dripped or ran out from one jar to another.

Haroun was a very wise and good ruler over the Moslems, and so he came to be called "al Rashid," which means "the Just." Do you remember what Greek was also called "the Just"?[3] Haroun used to disguise himself as a workman and go about among his people. He would talk with those he met along the street and in the market-place, trying to find out how they felt about his government and about things in general. He found they would talk freely to him when dressed in old clothes, for then they did not know who he was but thought him a fellow-workman. In this way, Haroun learned a great deal about his people's troubles and what they liked or didn't like about his rule. Then he would go back to his palace and give orders to have rules and laws made to correct anything that seemed wrong or unjust.

After Charlemagne died there was no one great enough or strong enough to hold the new Roman Empire together, and once again it broke up into small pieces, and "all the king's horses and all the king's men could not put it together again."

Saturday

HAVE READY

Bible · folk song · Ray's · *Understood Betsy* · a simple way to tell Pilgrim's Progress · Bernstein excerpt · nature notebook · evening walk plan

8:20 **Bible · Luke 19:10–27** PRESCHOOLER JOINS

Last week was Zacchaeus. This week starts with the seeking sentence, then the parable of the gold coins (minas). A nobleman, servants, one who hid the coin. Read once. Narrate the story. Do not allegorize.

8:35 **Folk song, Ray's, copywork, recitation**

Clean verses of "The Bold Grenadier." Next Ray's lesson. Copywork: the cupboard line. Recitation: Genesis 1:1, and "The Cupboard" if it has begun to stick.

9:20 **Literature · *Understood Betsy*, ch. 1**

"Aunt Harriet Has a Cough." First sitting of this book. The chapter is long. Stop at 20 minutes. Narrate who Elizabeth Ann lives with, and what went wrong. If unfinished, a second sitting after the notebook. Gutenberg 5347.

9:45 **Literature · *Pilgrim's Progress*, continued**

Still the gentle path, not the Apology. The dream-picture: a man in rags, a book, a burden on his back, "What shall I do?" Then stop. Narrate the picture. Evangelist waits.

10:00 **Composer and notebook** PRESCHOOLER JOINS

Five to eight minutes of Bernstein's *Jeremiah* while they draw Wednesday's web, shell, or ant. You may scribe one sentence they say, dated. Legal stream. No quiz. Keep the drawing to twenty minutes.

After 6 **Evening walk · *Lost Pines* or a creek**

Bastrop heat. Not midday. Prompt: find one invertebrate (orb-weaver, cricket, ant, millipede, cicada shell). Look. Watch for fire ants. Draw later only if they ask. A song on the way home still counts.

If you must cut: keep Bible, Ray's, *Understood Betsy*, and the evening walk. PP and Bernstein can be five minutes each, or wait.

How to teach Saturday

A new American story, a small piece of the dream, then heat-wise outdoor time.

Luke 19:10–27 — the gold coins

Last week ended with Zacchaeus. Verse 10 belongs to that scene, then the parable. AO calls it the Parable of the Gold Coin. It is the minas (or pounds), not the talents in Matthew 25. A nobleman goes away. Servants receive money to use. One hides his in a napkin. Read once. Both children. Narrate the story as a story. Do not turn the coins into a sermon on gifts. If the preschooler only holds “a man who hid his coin,” that is enough.

Understood Betsy, ch. 1

Dorothy Canfield Fisher, 1916. Public domain. Gutenberg 5347. Elizabeth Ann lives with Great-aunt Harriet and Aunt Frances, who “understand” her so carefully she is afraid of almost everything. A doctor comes for the child and hears Aunt Harriet cough. Plans change. The child may have to leave.

Stop at twenty minutes even if they beg. This chapter is longer than Island Story. If you are not done, take a second 15-minute sitting after the nature notebook and finish ch. 1 today. Week 3 is ch. 2, “Betsy Holds the Reins.” Do not start it.

Narration: who Elizabeth Ann lives with, and what went wrong. Do not explain the moral (overprotection, Vermont, self-reliance). The book will do that. The preschooler may listen if they will sit; they need not narrate.

Pilgrim’s Progress — the dream-picture

Week 1 told the frame: a man named Christian traveling to the Celestial City. This week give the first picture from the dream, then stop: rags, a book, a burden, “What shall I do?” You may read that opening from Bunyan (Gutenberg 131) or tell it in a few sentences. Narrate the picture. Do not read the verse Apology unless you have decided to match AO’s 72-week text exactly. Evangelist, the wicket-gate, and the City of Destruction by name can wait. Both children may hear this; keep it short.

Bernstein and the notebook

Same excerpt as last Saturday is fine. Five to eight minutes while they draw. You may scribe one dated sentence. Stop while the drawing still pleases them. Hearing it twice in two weeks is the lesson.

Evening walk — invertebrates, after 6

Lost Pines or a creek edge. Still hot in Bastrop at midday. Prompt: one invertebrate. Orb-weaver in porch light or between pines, cricket, katydid, ant, millipede under bark if it has rained, cicada shell still on a loblolly. Look. Not a field-guide test. Watch for fire ants. A song on the way home still counts. Week 2 is done when the walk is done.

Bible · Luke 19:10–27

King James Version. Project Gutenberg eBook #10. Public domain. The seeking sentence, then the parable of the pounds (minas).

10 For the Son of man is come to seek and to save that which was lost. 11 And as they heard these things, he added and spake a parable, because he was nigh to Jerusalem, and because they thought that the kingdom of God should immediately appear. 12 He said therefore, A certain nobleman went into a far country to receive for himself a kingdom, and to return. 13 And he called his ten servants, and delivered them ten pounds, and said unto them, Occupy till I come. 14 But his citizens hated him, and sent a message after him, saying, We will not have this man to reign over us. 15 And it came to pass, that when he was returned, having received the kingdom, then he commanded these servants to be called unto him, to whom he had given the money, that he might know how much every man had gained by trading. 16 Then came the first, saying, Lord, thy pound hath gained ten pounds. 17 And he said unto him, Well, thou good servant: because thou hast been faithful in a very little, have thou authority over ten cities. 18 And the second came, saying, Lord, thy pound hath gained five pounds. 19 And he said likewise to him, Be thou also over five cities. 20 And another came, saying, Lord, behold, here is thy pound, which I have kept laid up in a napkin: 21 For I feared thee, because thou art an austere man: thou takest up that thou layedst not down, and reapest that thou didst not sow. 22 And he saith unto him, Out of thine own mouth will I judge thee, thou wicked servant. Thou knewest that I was an austere man, taking up that I laid not down, and reaping that I did not sow: 23 Wherefore then gavest not thou my money into the bank, that at my coming I might have required mine own with usury? 24 And he said unto them that stood by, Take from him the pound, and give it to him that hath ten pounds. 25 (And they said unto him, Lord, he hath ten pounds.) 26 For I say unto you, That unto every one which hath shall be given; and from him that hath not, even that he hath shall be taken away from him. 27 But those mine enemies, which would not that I should reign over them, bring hither, and slay them before me.

Understood Betsy · Chapter 1 · Aunt Harriet Has a Cough

Dorothy Canfield Fisher, Understood Betsy (1916 / 1917). Project Gutenberg eBook #5347. Public domain. Full chapter, as assigned. It is long; stop the sitting at twenty minutes and finish later today if needed. Do not start chapter 2.

AUNT HARRIET HAS A COUGH

When this story begins, Elizabeth Ann, who is the heroine of it, was a little girl of nine, who lived with her Great-aunt Harriet in a medium-sized city in a medium-sized State in the middle of this country; and that's all you need to know about the place, for it's not the important thing in the story; and anyhow you know all about it because it was probably very much like the place you live in yourself.

Elizabeth Ann's Great-aunt Harriet was a widow who was not very rich or very poor, and she had one daughter, Frances, who gave piano lessons to little girls. They kept a "girl" whose name was Grace and who had asthma dreadfully and wasn't very much of a "girl" at all, being nearer fifty than forty. Aunt Harriet, who was very tender-hearted, kept her chiefly because she couldn't get any other place on account of her coughing so you could hear her all over the house.

So now you know the names of all the household. And this is how they looked: Aunt Harriet was very small and thin and old, Grace was very small and thin and middle-aged, Aunt Frances (for Elizabeth Ann called her "Aunt," although she was really, of course, a first-cousin-once-removed) was small and thin and if the light wasn't too strong might be called young, and Elizabeth Ann was very small and thin and little. And yet they all had plenty to eat. I wonder what was the matter with them?

It was certainly not because they were not good, for no womenkind in all the world had kinder hearts than they. You have heard how Aunt Harriet kept Grace (in spite of the fact that she was a very depressing person) on account of her asthma; and when Elizabeth Ann's father and mother both died when she was a baby, although there were many other cousins and uncles and aunts in the family, these two women fairly rushed upon the little baby-orphan, taking her home and surrounding her henceforth with the most loving devotion.

They had said to themselves that it was their manifest duty to save the dear little thing from the other relatives, who had no idea about how to bring up a sensitive, impressionable child, and they were sure, from the way Elizabeth Ann looked at six months, that she was going to be a sensitive, impressionable child. It is possible also that they were a little bored with their empty life in their rather forlorn, little brick house in the medium-sized city, and that they welcomed the occupation and new interests which a child would bring in.

But they thought that they chiefly desired to save dear Edward's child from the other kin, especially from the Putney cousins, who had written down from their Vermont farm that they would be glad to take the little girl into their family. But "ANYTHING but the Putneys!" said Aunt Harriet, a great many times. They were related only by marriage to her, and she had her own opinion of them as a stiffnecked, cold-hearted, undemonstrative, and hard set of New Englanders. "I boarded near them one summer when you were a baby, Frances, and I shall never forget the way they were treating some children visiting there! ... Oh, no, I don't mean they abused them or beat them ... but such lack of sympathy, such perfect indifference to the sacred sensitiveness of child-life, such a starving of the child-heart ... No, I shall never forget it! They had chores to do ... as though they had been hired men!"

Aunt Harriet never meant to say any of this when Elizabeth Ann could hear, but the little girl's ears were as sharp as little girls' ears always are, and long before she was nine she knew all about the opinion Aunt Harriet had of the Putneys. She did not know, to be sure, what "chores" were, but she took it confidently from Aunt Harriet's voice that they were something very, very dreadful.

There was certainly neither coldness nor hardness in the way Aunt Harriet and Aunt Frances treated Elizabeth Ann. They had really given themselves up to the new responsibility, especially Aunt Frances, who was very conscientious about everything. As soon as the baby came there to live, Aunt Frances stopped reading novels and magazines, and re-read one book after another which told her how to bring up children. And she joined a Mothers' Club which met once a week. And she took a correspondence course in mothercraft from a school in Chicago which teaches that business by mail. So you can see that by the time Elizabeth Ann was nine years old Aunt Frances must have known all that anybody can know about how to bring up children. And Elizabeth Ann got the benefit of it all.

She and her Aunt Frances were simply inseparable. Aunt Frances shared in all Elizabeth Ann's doings and even in all her thoughts. She was especially anxious to share all the little girl's thoughts, because she felt that the trouble with most children is that they are not understood, and she was determined that she would thoroughly understand Elizabeth Ann down to the bottom of her little mind. Aunt Frances (down in the bottom of her own mind) thought that her mother had never REALLY understood her, and she meant to do better by Elizabeth Ann. She also loved the little girl with all her heart, and longed, above everything in the world, to protect her from all harm and to keep her happy and strong and well.

And yet Elizabeth Ann was neither very strong nor well. And as to her being happy, you can judge for yourself when you have read all this story. She was very small for her age, with a rather pale face and big dark eyes which had in them a frightened, wistful expression that went to Aunt Frances's tender heart and made her ache to take care of Elizabeth Ann better and better.

Aunt Frances was afraid of a great many things herself, and she knew how to sympathize with timidity. She was always quick to reassure the little girl with all her might and main whenever there was anything to fear. When they were out walking (Aunt Frances took her out for a walk up one block and down another every single day, no matter how tired the music lessons had made her), the aunt's eyes were always on the alert to avoid anything which might frighten Elizabeth Ann. If a big dog trotted by, Aunt Frances always said, hastily: "There, there, dear! That's a NICE doggie, I'm sure. I don't believe he ever bites little girls.... MERCY! Elizabeth Ann, don't go near him! ... Here, darling, just get on the other side of Aunt Frances if he scares you so" (by that time Elizabeth Ann was always pretty well scared), "and perhaps we'd better just turn this corner and walk in the other direction." If by any chance the dog went in that direction too, Aunt Frances became a prodigy of valiant protection, putting the shivering little girl behind her, threatening the animal with her umbrella, and saying in a trembling voice, "Go away, sir! Go AWAY!"

Or if it thundered and lightened, Aunt Frances always dropped everything she might be doing and held Elizabeth Ann tightly in her arms until it was all over. And at night—Elizabeth Ann did not sleep very well—when the little girl woke up screaming with a bad dream, it was always dear Aunt Frances who came to her bedside, a warm wrapper over her nightgown so that she need not hurry back to her own room, a candle lighting up her tired, kind face. She always took the little girl into her thin arms and held her close against her thin breast. "TELL Aunt Frances all about your naughty dream, darling," she would murmur, "so's to get it off your mind!"

She had read in her books that you can tell a great deal about children's inner lives by analyzing their dreams, and besides, if she did not urge Elizabeth Ann to tell it, she was afraid the sensitive, nervous little thing would "lie awake and brood over it." This was the phrase she always used the next day to her mother when Aunt Harriet exclaimed about her paleness and the dark rings under her eyes. So she listened patiently while the little girl told her all about the fearful dreams she had, the great dogs with huge red mouths that ran after her, the Indians who scalped her, her schoolhouse on fire so that she had to jump from a third-story window and was all broken to bits—once in a while Elizabeth Ann got so interested in all this that she went on and made up more awful things even than she had dreamed, and told long stories which showed her to be a child of great imagination. But all these dreams and continuations of dreams Aunt Frances wrote down the first thing the next morning, and, with frequent references to a thick book full of hard words, she tried her best to puzzle out from them exactly what kind of little girl Elizabeth Ann really was.

There was one dream, however, that even conscientious Aunt Frances never tried to analyze, because it was too sad. Elizabeth Ann dreamed sometimes that she was dead and lay in a little white coffin with white roses over her. Oh, that made Aunt Frances cry, and so did Elizabeth Ann. It was very touching. Then, after a long, long time of talk and tears and sobs and hugs, the little girl would begin to get drowsy, and Aunt Frances would rock her to sleep in her arms, and lay her down ever so quietly, and slip away to try to get a little nap herself before it was time to get up.

At a quarter of nine every weekday morning Aunt Frances dropped whatever else she was doing, took Elizabeth Ann's little, thin, white hand protectingly in hers, and led her through the busy streets to the big brick school-building where the little girl had always gone to school. It was four stories high, and when all the classes were in session there were six hundred children under that one roof. You can imagine, perhaps, the noise there was on the playground just before school! Elizabeth Ann shrank from it with all her soul, and clung more tightly than ever to Aunt Frances's hand as she was led along through the crowded, shrieking masses of children. Oh, how glad she was that she had Aunt Frances there to take care of her, though as a matter of fact nobody noticed the little thin girl at all, and her very own classmates would hardly have known whether she came to school or not. Aunt Frances took her safely through the ordeal of the playground, then up the long, broad stairs, and pigeonholed her carefully in her own schoolroom. She was in the third grade,—3A, you understand, which is almost the fourth.

Then at noon Aunt Frances was waiting there, a patient, never-failing figure, to walk home with her little charge; and in the afternoon the same thing happened over again. On the way to and from school they talked about what had happened in the class. Aunt Frances believed in sympathizing with a child's life, so she always asked about every little thing, and remembered to inquire about the continuation of every episode, and sympathized with all her heart over the failure in mental arithmetic, and triumphed over Elizabeth Ann's beating the Schmidt girl in spelling, and was indignant over the teacher's having pets. Sometimes in telling over some very dreadful failure or disappointment Elizabeth Ann would get so wrought up that she would cry. This always brought the ready tears to Aunt Frances's kind eyes, and with many soothing words and nervous, tremulous caresses she tried to make life easier for poor little Elizabeth Ann. The days when they had cried they could neither of them eat much luncheon.

After school and on Saturdays there was always the daily walk, and there were lessons, all kinds of lessons—piano lessons of course, and nature-study lessons out of an excellent book Aunt Frances had bought, and painting lessons, and sewing lessons, and even a little French, although Aunt Frances was not very sure about her own pronunciation. She wanted to give the little girl every possible advantage, you see. They were really inseparable. Elizabeth Ann once said to some ladies calling on her aunts that whenever anything happened in school, the first thing she thought of was what Aunt Frances would think of it.

"Why is that?" they asked, looking at Aunt Frances, who was blushing with pleasure.

"Oh, she is so interested in my school work! And she UNDERSTANDS me!" said Elizabeth Ann, repeating the phrases she had heard so often.

Aunt Frances's eyes filled with happy tears. She called Elizabeth Ann to her and kissed her and gave her as big a hug as her thin arms could manage. Elizabeth Ann was growing tall very fast. One of the visiting ladies said that before long she would be as big as her auntie, and a troublesome young lady. Aunt Frances said: "I have had her from the time she was a little baby and there has scarcely been an hour she has been out of my sight. I'll always have her confidence. You'll always tell Aunt Frances EVERYTHING, won't you, darling?" Elizabeth Ann resolved to do this always, even if, as now, she often had to invent things to tell.

Aunt Frances went on, to the callers: "But I do wish she weren't so thin and pale and nervous. I suppose it is the exciting modern life that is so bad for children. I try to see that she has plenty of fresh air. I go out with her for a walk every single day. But we have taken all the walks around here so often that we're rather tired of them. It's often hard to know how to get her out enough. I think I'll have to get the doctor to come and see her and perhaps give her a tonic." To Elizabeth Ann she added, hastily: "Now don't go getting notions in your head, darling. Aunt Frances doesn't think there's anything VERY much the matter with you. You'll be all right again soon if you just take the doctor's medicine nicely. Aunt Frances will take care of her precious little girl. SHE'll make the bad sickness go

away.” Elizabeth Ann, who had not known before that she was sick, had a picture of herself lying in the little white coffin, all covered over with white.... In a few minutes Aunt Frances was obliged to excuse herself from her callers and devote herself entirely to taking care of Elizabeth Ann.

So one day, after this had happened several times, Aunt Frances really did send for the doctor, who came briskly in, just as Elizabeth Ann had always seen him, with his little square black bag smelling of leather, his sharp eyes, and the air of bored impatience which he always wore in that house. Elizabeth Ann was terribly afraid to see him, for she felt in her bones he would say she had galloping consumption and would die before the leaves cast a shadow. This was a phrase she had picked up from Grace, whose conversation, perhaps on account of her asthma, was full of references to early graves and quick declines.

And yet—did you ever hear of such a case before?—although Elizabeth Ann when she first stood up before the doctor had been quaking with fear lest he discover some deadly disease in her, she was very much hurt indeed when, after thumping her and looking at her lower eyelid inside out, and listening to her breathing, he pushed her away with a little jerk and said: “There’s nothing in the world the matter with that child. She’s as sound as a nut! What she needs is ...”—he looked for a moment at Aunt Frances’s thin, anxious face, with the eyebrows drawn together in a knot of conscientiousness, and then he looked at Aunt Harriet’s thin, anxious face with the eyebrows drawn up that very same way, and then he glanced at Grace’s thin, anxious face peering from the door waiting for his verdict—and then he drew a long breath, shut his lips and his little black case very tightly, and did not go on to say what it was that Elizabeth Ann needed.

Of course Aunt Frances didn’t let him off as easily as that, you may be sure. She fluttered around him as he tried to go, and she said all sorts of fluttery things to him, like “But, Doctor, she hasn’t gained a pound in three months ... and her sleep ... and her appetite ... and her nerves ...”

[Illustration: Elizabeth Ann stood up before the doctor.]

The doctor said back to her, as he put on his hat, all the things doctors always say under such conditions: “More beefsteak ... plenty of fresh air ... more sleep ... SHE’ll be all right ...” but his voice did not sound as though he thought what he was saying amounted to much. Nor did Elizabeth Ann. She had hoped for some spectacular red pills to be taken every half-hour, like those Grace’s doctor gave her whenever she felt low in her mind.

And just then something happened which changed Elizabeth Ann’s life forever and ever. It was a very small thing, too. Aunt Harriet coughed. Elizabeth Ann did not think it at all a bad-sounding cough in comparison with Grace’s hollow whoop; Aunt Harriet had been coughing like that ever since the cold weather set in, for three or four months now, and nobody had thought anything of it, because they were all so much occupied in taking care of the sensitive, nervous little girl who needed so much care.

And yet, at the sound of that little discreet cough behind Aunt Harriet’s hand, the doctor whirled around and fixed his sharp eyes on her, with all the bored, impatient look gone, the first time Elizabeth Ann had ever seen him look interested. “What’s that? What’s that?” he said, going over quickly to Aunt Harriet. He snatched out of his little bag a shiny thing with two rubber tubes attached, and he put the ends of the tubes in his ears and the shiny thing up against Aunt Harriet, who was saying, “It’s nothing, Doctor ... a little teasing cough I’ve had this winter. And I meant to tell you, too, but I forgot it, that that sore spot on my lungs doesn’t go away as it ought to.”

The doctor motioned her very impolitely to stop talking, and listened very hard through his little tubes. Then he turned around and looked at Aunt Frances as though he were angry at her. He said, “Take the child away and then come back here yourself.”

And that was almost all that Elizabeth Ann ever knew of the forces which swept her away from the life which had always gone on, revolving about her small person, exactly the same ever since she could remember.

You have heard so much about tears in the account of Elizabeth Ann’s life so far that I won’t tell you much about the few days which followed, as the family talked over and hurriedly prepared to obey the doctor’s verdict, which was that Aunt Harriet was very, very sick and must go away at once to a warm climate, and Aunt Frances must go, too,

but not Elizabeth Ann, for Aunt Frances would need to give all her time to taking care of Aunt Harriet. And anyhow the doctor didn't think it best, either for Aunt Harriet or for Elizabeth Ann, to have them in the same house.

Grace couldn't go of course, but to everybody's surprise she said she didn't mind, because she had a bachelor brother, who kept a grocery store, who had been wanting her for years to go and keep house for him. She said she had stayed on just out of conscientiousness because she knew Aunt Harriet couldn't get along without her! And if you notice, that's the way things often happen to very, very conscientious people.

Elizabeth Ann, however, had no grocer brother. She had, it is true, a great many relatives, and of course it was settled she should go to some of them till Aunt Frances could take her back. For the time being, just now, while everything was so distracted and confused, she was to go to stay with the Lathrop cousins, who lived in the same city, although it was very evident that the Lathrops were not perfectly crazy with delight over the prospect.

Still, something had to be done at once, and Aunt Frances was so frantic with the packing up, and the moving men coming to take the furniture to storage, and her anxiety over her mother—she had switched to Aunt Harriet, you see, all the conscientiousness she had lavished on Elizabeth Ann—nothing much could be extracted from her about Elizabeth Ann. “Just keep her for the present, Molly!” she said to Cousin Molly Lathrop. “I'll do something soon. I'll write you. I'll make another arrangement ... but just NOW....”

Her voice was quavering on the edge of tears, and Cousin Molly Lathrop, who hated scenes, said hastily, “Yes, oh, yes, of course. For the present ...” and went away, thinking that she didn't see why she should have ALL the disagreeable things to do. When she had her husband's tyrannical old mother to take care of, wasn't that enough, without adding to the household such a nervous, spoiled, morbid young one as Elizabeth Ann!

Elizabeth Ann did not of course for a moment dream that Cousin Molly was thinking any such things about her, but she could not help seeing that Cousin Molly was not any too enthusiastic about taking her in; and she was already feeling terribly forlorn about the sudden, unexpected change in Aunt Frances, who had been SO wrapped up in her and now was just as much wrapped up in Aunt Harriet. Do you know, I am sorry for Elizabeth Ann, and, what's more, I have been ever since this story began.

Well, since I promised you that I was not going to tell about more tears, I won't say a single word about the day when the two aunts went away on the train, for there is nothing much but tears to tell about, except perhaps an absent look in Aunt Frances's eyes which hurt the little girl's feelings dreadfully.

And then Cousin Molly took the hand of the sobbing little girl and led her back to the Lathrop house. But if you think you are now going to hear about the Lathrops, you are quite mistaken, for just at this moment old Mrs. Lathrop took a hand in the matter. She was Cousin Molly's husband's mother, and, of course, no relation at all to Elizabeth Ann, and so was less enthusiastic than anybody else. All that Elizabeth Ann ever saw of this old lady, who now turned the current of her life again, was her head, sticking out of a second-story window; and that's all that you need to know about her, either. It was a very much agitated old head, and it bobbed and shook with the intensity with which the imperative old voice called upon Cousin Molly and Elizabeth Ann to stop right there where they were on the front walk.

“The doctor says that what's the matter with Bridget is scarlet fever, and we've all got to be quarantined. There's no earthly sense bringing that child in to be sick and have it, and be nursed, and make the quarantine twice as long!”

“But, Mother!” called Cousin Molly, “I can't leave the child in the middle of the street!”

Elizabeth Ann was actually glad to hear her say that, because she was feeling so awfully unwanted, which is, if you think of it, not a very cheerful feeling for a little girl who has been the hub round which a whole household was revolving.

“You don't HAVE to!” shouted old Mrs. Lathrop out of her second-story window. Although she did not add “You gump!” aloud, you could feel she was meaning just that. “You don't have to! You can just send her to the Putney cousins. All nonsense about her not going there in the first place. They invited her the minute they heard of Harriet's

being so bad. They're the natural ones to take her in. Abigail is her mother's own aunt, and Ann is her own first-cousin-once-removed ... just as close as Harriet and Frances are, and MUCH closer than you! And on a farm and all ... just the place for her!"

"But how under the sun, Mother!" shouted Cousin Molly back, "can I GET her to the Putneys'? You can't send a child of nine a thousand miles without ..."

Old Mrs. Lathrop looked again as though she were saying "You gump!" and said aloud, "Why, there's James, going to New York on business in a few days anyhow. He can just go now, and take her along and put her on the right train at Albany. If he wires from here, they'll meet her in Hillsboro."

And that was just what happened. Perhaps you may have guessed by this time that when old Mrs. Lathrop issued orders they were usually obeyed. As to who the Bridget was who had the scarlet fever, I know no more than you. I take it, from the name, she was the cook. Unless, indeed, old Mrs. Lathrop made her up for the occasion, which I think she would have been quite capable of doing, don't you?

At any rate, with no more ifs or ands, Elizabeth Ann's satchel was packed, and Cousin James Lathrop's satchel was packed, and the two set off together, the big, portly, middle-aged man quite as much afraid of his mother as Elizabeth Ann was. But he was going to New York, and it is conceivable that he thought once or twice on the trip that there were good times in New York as well as business engagements, whereas poor Elizabeth Ann was being sent straight to the one place in the world where there were no good times at all. Aunt Harriet had said so, ever so many times. Poor Elizabeth Ann!

This is the whole of chapter 1. Week 3 is chapter 2, "Betsy Holds the Reins." Do not start it.

The Pilgrim's Progress · next sitting

John Bunyan, Gutenberg #131. Public domain. Continues after week 1's opening dream-paragraph (rags, book, burden, "What shall I do?"). This sitting: Christian at home, the cry "What shall I do to be saved?", Evangelist, the roll "Flee from the wrath to come." Stop before the wicket-gate.

In this plight, therefore, he went home and refrained himself as long as he could, that his wife and children should not perceive his distress; but he could not be silent long, because that his trouble increased. Wherefore at length he brake his mind to his wife and children; and thus he began to talk to them: O my dear wife, said he, and you the children of my bowels, I, your dear friend, am in myself undone by reason of a burden that lieth hard upon me; moreover, I am for certain informed that this our city will be burned with fire from heaven; in which fearful overthrow, both myself, with thee my wife, and you my sweet babes, shall miserably come to ruin, except (the which yet I see not) some way of escape can be found, whereby we may be delivered. At this his relations were sore amazed; not for that they believed that what he had said to them was true, but because they thought that some frenzy distemper had got into his head; therefore, it drawing towards night, and they hoping that sleep might settle his brains, with all haste they got him to bed. But the night was as troublesome to him as the day; wherefore, instead of sleeping, he spent it in sighs and tears. So, when the morning was come, they would know how he did. He told them, Worse and worse: he also set to talking to them again; but they began to be hardened. They also thought to drive away his distemper by harsh and surly carriages to him; sometimes they would deride, sometimes they would chide, and sometimes they would quite neglect him. Wherefore he began to retire himself to his chamber, to pray for and pity them, and also to condole his own misery; he would also walk solitarily in the fields, sometimes reading, and sometimes praying: and thus for some days he spent his time.

Now, I saw, upon a time, when he was walking in the fields, that he was, as he was wont, reading in his book, and greatly distressed in his mind; and, as he read, he burst out, as he had done before, crying, "What shall I do to be saved?"

I saw also that he looked this way and that way, as if he would run; yet he stood still, because, as I perceived, he could not tell which way to go. I looked then, and saw a man named Evangelist coming to him and asked, Wherefore dost thou cry?

He answered, Sir, I perceive by the book in my hand, that I am condemned to die, and after that to come to judgement; and I find that I am not willing to do the first, nor able to do the second.

Then said Evangelist, Why not willing to die, since this life is attended with so many evils? The man answered, Because I fear that this burden is upon my back will sink me lower than the grave, and I shall fall into Tophet. And, Sir, if I be not fit to go to prison, I am not fit, I am sure, to go to judgement, and from thence to execution; and the thoughts of these things make me cry.

Then said Evangelist, If this be thy condition, why standest thou still? He answered, Because I know not whither to go. Then he gave him a parchment roll, and there was written within, Flee from the wrath to come.

Stop here. Evangelist has given the roll. The wicket-gate waits. Do not read on today.